

Cron Jobs & Heartbeat

Prompts and quick reference for this lesson

This PDF contains the prompts from the Cron Jobs & Heartbeat lesson plus a quick reference for when to use which. Copy and paste the prompts into Telegram or your dashboard chat, and adjust the details (time, timezone, tasks) to fit your own schedule.

When to Use Which

	Cron Job	Heartbeat
What it does	Runs at a specific time you choose	Wakes up at regular intervals (e.g. every 30 minutes)
Best for	Daily briefings, weekly reports, scheduled reminders	Watching for urgent emails, upcoming meetings, alerts
How often	Once a day, once a week, whatever you set	Every 30 minutes (48 times a day)
Cost	Low — runs once at the scheduled time	Can add up fast if overloaded with tasks

Simple rule: If it needs to happen at a specific time, use a cron job. If it needs to be watched for continuously, use the heartbeat.

Prompts Used in the Lesson

Set up a daily morning briefing (cron job)

This creates a scheduled task that fires once a day at 8am and delivers a summary to your Telegram. Change the time and location to match your own schedule.

Create a daily cron job. Every morning at 8am, check the weather for London, check my Google Calendar for the day, scan my Gmail for anything urgent, and send me a summary on Telegram with my top priorities for the day.

Set up background monitoring (heartbeat)

This turns on the heartbeat so your agent quietly checks for urgent items every 30 minutes. It only messages you when something actually needs your attention.

Enable heartbeat and set it to run every 30 minutes. On each heartbeat, check for any upcoming calendar events in the next hour and any new urgent emails. Only message me on Telegram if something actually needs my attention. Keep it lightweight and don't use too many tokens.

Watch Your Costs

The heartbeat runs 48 times a day. Every single run loads your full context window and uses tokens. If you pack the heartbeat with lots of tasks and run it on an expensive model, the costs add up very fast. Keep your heartbeat lean — only tasks that genuinely need continuous monitoring. Everything else should be a cron job. And make sure your heartbeat is set to use a cheap model through your routing rules.

Other Useful Prompts

Disable heartbeat (to save costs)

Disable the heartbeat and confirm it's turned off.

Check what cron jobs are running

Show me all my active cron jobs with their schedules.

Delete a cron job

Delete the cron job called [name] and confirm it's removed.

Run a cron job manually to test

Run the [name] cron job now so I can see what the output looks like.

Google Workspace not working in cron jobs? If your cron job can access the web but not your calendar or Gmail, check the separate troubleshooting guide attached to this lesson — it walks you through the GOG keyring fix step by step.